

MANDAR KASHIKAR

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SUMMARY

Senior Product Manager with 6 years leading technical B2B commerce and payments products, including 4+ years taking them from concept to launch, and 14 years of overall experience across product management, strategy consulting, analytics, and engineering. Most recently took Elavon Business Solutions from concept to launch, combining commerce and payments through integrations spanning account provisioning, SSO, payment processing, and POS hardware. Own product strategy for the Retail SMB segment, lead delivery across 6+ product and engineering teams, and manage a strategic partnership with a ~\$1M annual development budget. Actively building with AI (github.com/mandarkashikar) and enabling PM work with it.

EXPERIENCE

Elavon — Top 6 Merchant Payments Company, Owned by US Bank

Toronto, Canada

Senior Product Manager, Vertical Lead – Retail SMB Commerce

January 2025 – Present

- **Product Strategy:** Defined the vision and product strategy for [Elavon Business Solutions \(EBS\)](#), unifying online commerce, in-store commerce, and payments into one B2B platform. Established the company's first SaaS pricing model and simplified packaging, shifting the offering from standalone gateways and terminals to a unified commerce platform. Delivered a portfolio of 2 products with 3 pricing tiers each, launching the first in 9 months and the second 4 months later.
- **Product Growth:** Enabled 5 sales channels (DIY, direct sales, FI partners, the US Bank channel, and strategic partners) and trained ~100 sellers, scaling EBS to ~1800 merchants at 100–150 net new per month and projected to reach \$2M ARR and a \$40M annual transaction-volume run rate by the end of the first year, with expansion into Canada and the EU underway.
- **Technical Integration:** Led product delivery for a cobranded, cloud-based commerce platform integrating Wix with Elavon's payments infrastructure across onboarding, account provisioning, SSO, embedded UI, payment processing, and POS. Drove design direction with UX partners on the embedded and cobranded UI, unifying these capabilities into a connected merchant experience across web, mobile, handheld POS, and tabletop POS.
- **Strategic Partnership:** Owned the commercial and product relationship with Wix, including contracting, risk management, a ~\$1M annual development budget, and partner compensation. Aligned roadmap commitments across both companies, managing delivery dependencies and launch coordination to deliver joint product capabilities and resolve merchant issues.
- **Product Analytics:** Ran a post-mortem of the sale-to-activation funnel, building a data layer that unified sales, onboarding, and activation data from PowerBI, Adobe, Salesforce, and Splunk to isolate the drop-off points. Validated the findings across 50+ merchant interviews, then drove the design of a rebuilt onboarding flow and stood up a dedicated activation team, raising activation from 40% to ~65% and cutting time to activate from 40 days to 19.
- **Cross-Functional Leadership:** Led pilot and GA launch planning across 15+ functions and 5+ dependent teams, including engineering, design, QA, operations, marketing, go-to-market, sales, training, legal, compliance, risk, pricing, and finance. Aligned teams on scope and priorities, managed cross-team dependencies, and coordinated budget allocations to keep delivery on schedule.
- **People Leadership:** Led 6+ scrum and product teams staffed with ~50 developers and drove their roadmap to deliver the end-to-end merchant experience, hiring, mentoring, and directly managing 3 product owners.
- **Compliance & Risk:** Led compliance across PCI DSS scope, cardholder data protection, card-brand rules, and legal and risk reviews, aligning internal and external teams on requirements and delivery timelines to keep the product launch on schedule.
- **AI Enablement:** Built an AI-powered "PM second brain" in VS Code with GitHub Copilot and Claude/Codex, wiring 15+ custom skills into US Bank's internal Confluence and JIRA MCPs. Currently using it to run an AI-assisted SDLC end to end, from discovery and requirements through user stories, tickets, and prototypes. Led internal AI adoption workshops to spread the practice to other product teams.

talech — Cloud-Based Point-of-Sale & Commerce Platform, Owned by US Bank

Palo Alto, CA / Toronto, Canada

Senior Product Manager – Web POS

August 2022 – January 2025

- **Product Leadership:** Led vision, discovery, prioritization, and delivery of core POS features, including payment links and virtual terminal, across the merchant web platform and end-customer microsites, managing 2 scrum teams and 15+ full-stack developers.

- **Platform Migration:** Migrated 50,000+ merchants onto a revamped web platform with no disruption to live payments, driving adoption through in-app notifications, merchant webinars, and channel-partner enablement. Redesigned the merchant reporting experience in the same effort, lifting report downloads and engagement 10%.
- **Market Research:** Ran the market research behind a new product: 25+ in-store visits with SF Bay Area merchants, 25+ online interviews, and a survey across 7,000+ merchants in the US Bank consortium, which surfaced the 20+ independent marketing tools small businesses were stitching together. Paired that with competitor analysis showing the market consolidating around all-in-one platforms and shaped the strategy for an integrated marketing and POS product, identifying a \$20M annual revenue opportunity across existing and new business.
- **Payments Integration:** Shipped checkout features (hosted fields, Checkout.js, lightbox, and hosted page) alongside commerce/growth features including online ordering, invoicing, gift purchases, and loyalty, driving \$200M+ in annual transaction volume.

TriNet Inc. — Industry-Leading HR Technology Company

Senior Product Manager – Benefits Product Strategy

Product Manager

San Jose, CA

December 2021 – August 2022

March 2021 – December 2021

- **Product Launch:** Led discovery and pilot for a new benefits product targeting the underserved PEO market across 4 states, reaching \$250K in annual contract value within 3 months.
- **Product Growth:** Led the pilot launch and expansion of a new benefits product, driving CX improvements and third-party platform API integrations, generating \$6M in volume growth within 6 months.

Ernst & Young (EY) Parthenon — Top-4 Strategy Consulting Firm

Senior Consultant – Strategy and Analytics

Arlington, VA

August 2019 – March 2021

- **Cost Optimization:** Analyzed current-state labor distribution and modeled a future-state workforce across offshoring, outsourcing, and consolidation for an \$18B healthcare client, identifying \$29M in cost savings.
- **Business Case:** Built the business case for a \$20B healthcare client's employee retention program, quantifying attrition's impact on productivity and NPS to surface \$140M in annual savings.
- **Data Science:** Built regression and forecasting models in R and analyzed 8,000+ open-text survey responses plus culture data spanning 12,000+ individuals, producing the insights and persona clusters that shaped a global foundation's return-to-work policy and a major university's culture transformation.
- **Executive Communication:** Presented findings and recommendations directly to C-suite and board audiences across 4 engagements, including the CEO of Conifer Health, the COO of the Bill & Melinda Gates Foundation, the CEO of LabCorp, and the board of trustees at USC.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

- MPOWER Financing, Growth Strategy Intern (May 2018 – Dec 2018): Launched a customer referral program that generated \$2.2M in loan volume in 2 months.
- Retail eCommerce & SMB Consulting Startups, Marketing and Operations Manager (Sep 2015 – Jun 2017): Launched three service offerings and a go-to-market strategy, securing the first 13 clients and \$20K in monthly revenue.
- Philips Medical Devices, Assistant Manager – New Product Development (Jan 2012 – Feb 2016): Led process improvement initiatives across 35 global suppliers, achieving \$600K in annual savings.

EDUCATION

University of Maryland, College Park — MBA & MS, Marketing Analytics

2017 – 2019

University of Pune — Bachelor of Technology, Industrial Engineering

2008 – 2012

SKILLS & CERTIFICATIONS

- **Product Strategy & Vision:** 0→1 development, roadmap ownership, prioritization, ambiguous problem framing.
- **Growth & Discovery:** Funnel analysis, customer and market research, competitive analysis, pricing, GTM.
- **Technical & Data Fluency:** Cloud platforms, API/webhook integrations, PSP layers, PCI DSS, ETL, SQL, Python, R.
- **Product & AI Stack:** Jira, Confluence, Figma, VS Code, GitHub Copilot, Claude/Codex, MCP, Replit.
- **Certifications:** Product School PM, Reforge Product Strategy, IBM AI Product Management, GoPractice AI/ML Simulator.